

MVP FEASIBILITY REPORT · 2026

Acumen.

Practise judgement before it counts.

Acumen helps emerging business leaders practise realistic decisions, understand their leadership tendencies, and connect with peers whose strengths complement their own.

PRODUCT

Acumen
Web app prototype

MODULE

MSIN0144
Group Coursework

GROUP 50

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01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A feasible MVP for emerging leaders

Young people preparing for management roles are taught about leadership but rarely get to practise it. Case studies are abstract, internships are scarce, and traditional psychometrics are slow, expensive, and detached from the work itself. **Acumen** addresses this gap with short, scenario-driven simulations that surface how a user actually decides under pressure.

The beachhead is business students, young professionals, and aspiring founders; the premium later segment is next-generation (*NextGen*) successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses where leadership transitions carry significant economic stakes [3][1]. The MVP demonstrates a four-step loop — **Simulate, Signal, Connect, Improve** — across three live web scenarios, with *The Succession Crisis* as flagship. The model layers freemium individual access with university cohort pilots toward a premium NextGen pathway; an 18-response survey and three interviews give directional evidence, with broader validation as the next step.

Verdict. Acumen is feasible as an early MVP — the simulation, feedback, and peer-discovery loop is demonstrated. Further user testing and scoring validation are needed before high-stakes use.

Why now, and who this is actually for

Three forces converge: a generation of young leaders who lack practical experience, a documented succession bottleneck in Asia-Pacific family businesses, and growing acceptance of simulation-based assessment in serious professional contexts.

Who Acumen is built for

Acumen is built for anyone preparing to make business decisions earlier than expected. That includes family-business heirs, who sit at the sharpest end of the readiness gap, but it is broader than that: students about to run a society or capstone project, early-career professionals promoted into management before training catches up, aspiring founders making their first hire, and analysts asked for an opinion in rooms above their pay grade. The common thread is simple: they have read about leadership, they have not practised it, and the cost of their first poor judgement call is paid in real reputation. NextGen successors are an important later-stage segment with the highest willingness to pay, but they sit on top of a far larger pool of users who share the same underlying problem.

SEGMENT	TRIGGER TO USE ACUMEN	WHERE WE REACH THEM
Business and engineering students	Recruiting, society leadership, capstone projects	UCL, society partnerships, course tie-ins
Young professionals (0–4 years)	First promotion, first hire, first cross-functional decision	LinkedIn communities, employer learning & development programmes
Aspiring founders	Pre-incorporation, first co-founder hire, first investor pitch	Accelerators, founder communities, university entrepreneurship offices
NextGen successors (later)	Joining family business, governance training	Family-office networks, regional advisors

The "leadership-readiness" gap

Business education is rich in frameworks but poor in practice. Internships compress months of work into weeks of memo writing, and graduate schemes defer real decision authority to year two or three. Serious games are increasingly used to assess and develop soft skills including problem solving, decision-making, and communication [14]. McKinsey's Game-Based Innovation Lab shows that simulation-based assessment now sits inside serious professional contexts, not entertainment [4].

Why an Asia-Pacific focus

The premium segment is concentrated in Asia-Pacific, where family businesses dominate and a generational handover is underway. Between 2023 and 2030, high-net-worth Asia-Pacific families are expected to transfer around USD 5.8 trillion to the next generation [3]. PwC finds **43%** of Indonesian NextGen citing senior resistance to handover and **19%** of family businesses delaying succession [1]. Sukamdani notes Indonesian family companies reach around 40% of market capitalisation and contribute over 80% of GDP [7]. The anchor matters not because heirs will fund development, but because it gives Acumen a defensible reason to exist beyond a generic edtech pitch.

\$5.8T

APAC NEXTGEN WEALTH
TRANSFER 2023–2030 [3]

43%

INDONESIAN NEXTGEN
CITING SENIOR RESISTANCE
[1]

917

INTERVIEWS IN PWC GLOBAL
NEXTGEN SURVEY 2024 [2]

What Acumen is

Acumen helps emerging business leaders practise realistic decisions, understand their leadership tendencies, and connect with peers whose strengths complement their own.

The product is built around a single repeatable loop. Each session begins with a realistic business scenario, presents the user with branching decisions under time and information constraints, then converts those choices into a research-informed leadership signal. The signal is developmental, not diagnostic. It points the user toward what to practise next, and toward peers whose strengths complement their own.

The conceptual framing draws on established theory: upper-echelons [10], Vroom-Yetton's normative model [11], Hersey-Blanchard's situational model [12], and Rest's moral development work [13] together inform how decisions, participation, readiness, and ethical prompts are structured.

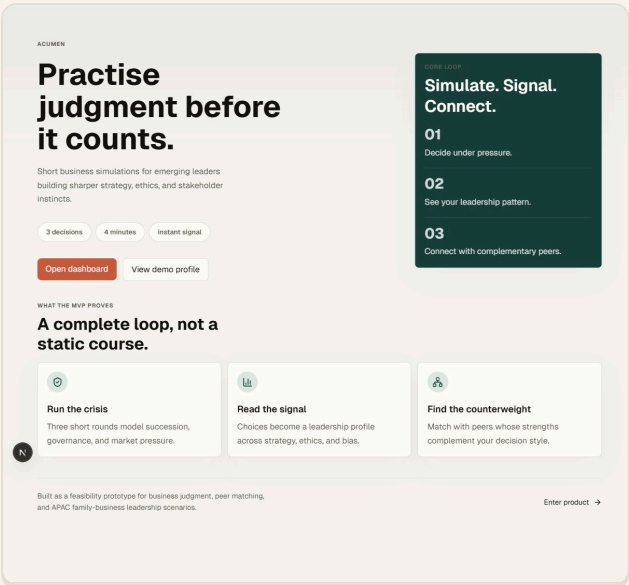


FIG. 1 Acumen introduces a simple promise: practise business judgement before it counts.

The product loop

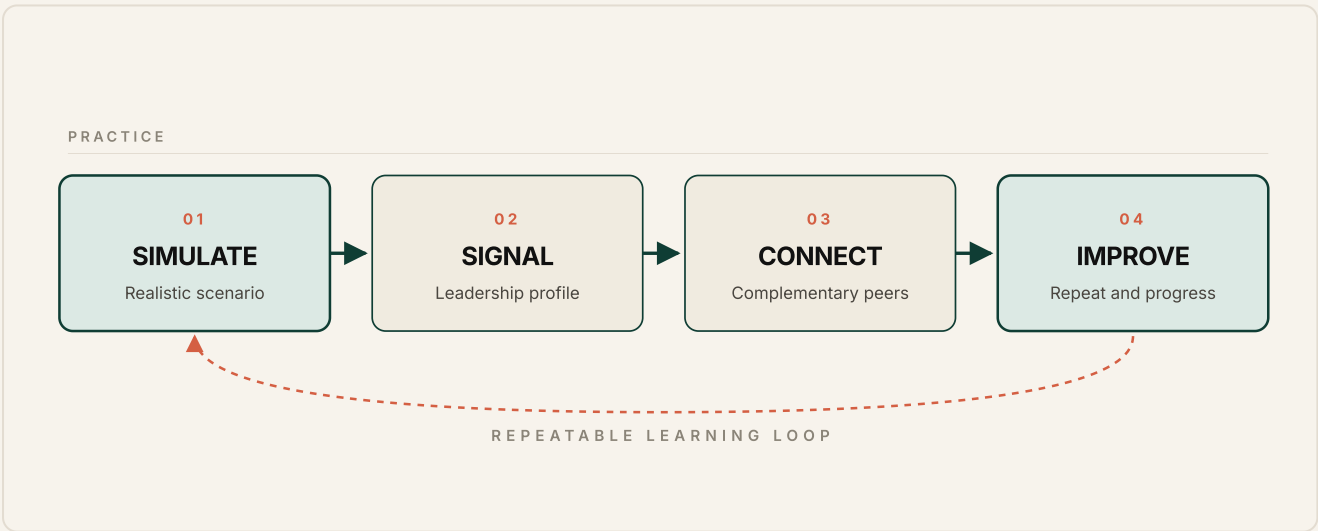


FIG. 2 Acumen turns business learning into a repeatable loop: users practise realistic decisions, receive feedback, connect with useful peers, and return to improve.

How a user actually uses Acumen

The MVP walkthrough shows Acumen's core loop: a user enters through a simple value proposition, completes a business simulation, receives a leadership signal, and is guided toward peers with complementary strengths.

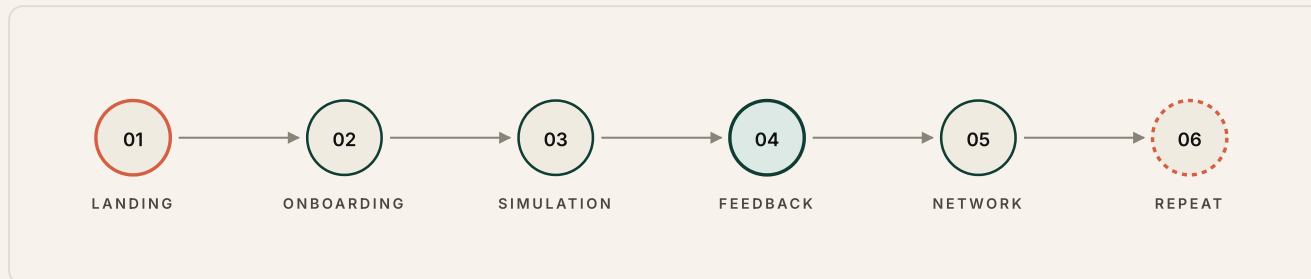


FIG. 3 Typical Acumen use case, shown as a sequence rather than a screen collage.

Step 1 · Onboarding

A first-time user lands on a single-promise home screen and is taken into a short onboarding flow. Acumen asks what the user wants to develop: decision-making under pressure, ethical judgement, conflict navigation, or strategic communication. These selections shape the order in which scenarios appear and the framing of feedback.

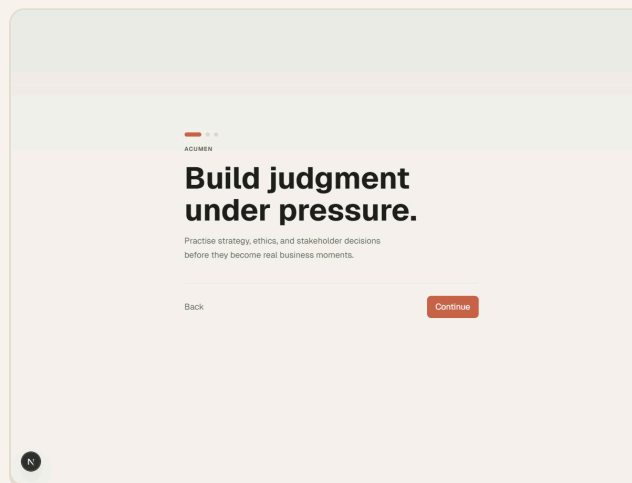


FIG. 4 Onboarding frames the experience around goals and skill development.

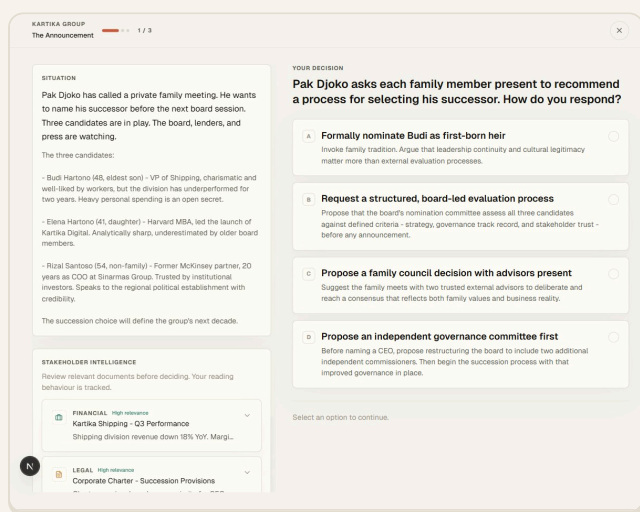


FIG. 5 The simulation places users in realistic trade-off decisions.

Step 2 · The Succession Crisis

The user enters *The Succession Crisis*, a scenario in which a family-controlled mid-cap business must decide how to handle a contested leadership handover. The user faces sequenced decisions involving a politically connected board member, a capable but unfamiliar external candidate, and a long-serving family executive. Each decision is timed and information is deliberately incomplete, mirroring real management contexts. The scenario draws on succession themes documented in the PwC Indonesia work [1] and the literature on the weight of political and family ties in the region [9].

From decisions to signal to network

Step 3 · A research-informed signal

Once the simulation closes, Acumen converts decision patterns into a developmental profile across five dimensions: strategic judgement, ethical reasoning, stakeholder management, decisiveness, and adaptability. The profile is presented as developmental feedback rather than a high-stakes score. Imbellus and McKinsey piloted and calibrated simulation-based assessment with McKinsey candidates from 2017 [5][8]; Acumen does not claim equivalent validation at MVP stage.

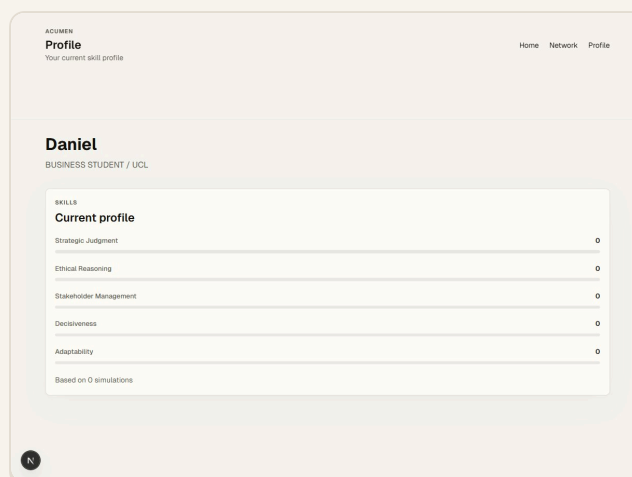


FIG. 6 Feedback converts choices into a research-informed leadership signal.

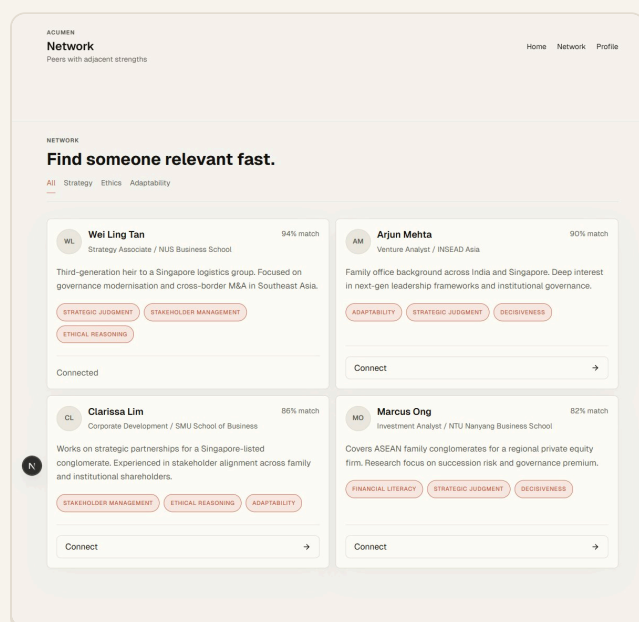


FIG. 7 Peer matching turns individual feedback into social learning.

Step 4 · Peer matching as social learning

The leadership signal then suggests peers with complementary strengths, on the principle that the same simulated experience produces a common vocabulary for collaboration. Matching at MVP stage uses profile-vector similarity over decision tendencies; deeper matching logic, CV parsing, and a global map view are roadmap features.

Step 5 · Repeat and track

Repetition is what turns the loop into learning. The profile view records how a user's signal shifts over time. Two further scenarios, *The Fading Division* and *The Authority Bypass*, broaden the practice surface beyond succession. The MVP demonstrates the core simulation, feedback, and peer loop. CV parsing, global maps, recruiter tools, certificates, and deeper matching are roadmap features, not current MVP features.

What actually has to work

Acumen sits in an unusual technical position. The interface is simple, but the components behind it are not. Three carry most of the product risk: the simulation engine, the scoring system, and the peer matching layer. Everything else is conventional web engineering.

The three components that matter

SIMULATION ENGINE A small state machine with four phases (deciding, ethical, twist, complete) drives users through scenario rounds, stakeholder document review, ethical prompts, and decision selection. Scenarios are stored as typed data, not hardcoded UI, so new ones can be added without rewriting the engine.	SCORING SYSTEM Every choice is tagged behind the scenes. Those tags roll up into five scores describing how the user tends to decide: strategic judgement, ethical reasoning, stakeholder management, decisiveness, and adaptability. Each is anchored in established theory (Upper Echelons, Rest, Vroom-Yetton, Hersey-Blanchard, OODA). Validation against expert ratings is on the roadmap.	PEER MATCHING Matching surfaces peers with complementary rather than identical profile vectors. At MVP scale it runs against a seeded set of demo profiles; real matching becomes testable at roughly fifty active users.
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Stack and architecture

LAYER	CHOICE	WHY
Framework	Next.js with React and TypeScript	Routing across distinct app views (landing, onboarding, simulation, feedback, profile, network); types make the data model self-documenting.
Styling	Tailwind CSS; shared visual system in <code>globals.css</code>	Editorial palette stays consistent across pages without a heavy design system.
Interaction	Lucide React icons; Framer Motion for transitions	Animation is restrained; transitions punctuate the loop rather than decorate it.
State	Global React context provider; persisted to <code>localStorage</code> with hydration check	The demo journey survives page refreshes; protected pages do not redirect before saved state has loaded.
Scenario data	Strongly-typed TypeScript data files	New scenarios are added as data, not code. <i>The Succession Crisis</i> , <i>The Authority Bypass</i> , and <i>The Fading Division</i> already use this pattern.
Auth and data	Email login; anonymised profile vectors only	Reduces compliance surface and is honest with users about what is collected.

From decision to signal

How a decision becomes a signal

The simulation reads a scenario from typed data and presents the user with rounds containing situations, options, and stakeholder documents. The state machine moves the user through deciding, optional ethical prompts, a final twist, then completion. On completion, the array of chosen options is passed to the scoring function, which maps each decision to its hidden tags across the five dimensions, applies bias detection, and produces an overall score plus a Vroom-Yetton style classification. The user is redirected to feedback, where the profile is rendered as plain-language summaries with dimension bars. The same profile vector then drives the network view, where peers are surfaced by complementarity rather than similarity.

Honest limitations and IP

Acumen is a research-informed prototype, not a fully validated assessment platform. The scoring system is internally structured and framework-based, but it has not yet been externally validated against a large sample or real-world leadership outcomes. The peer matching layer currently uses demo data rather than a live algorithm, and several roadmap features (CV parsing, global maps, recruiter tools, certificates) are deliberately out of scope at MVP. Acumen's defensible IP is not the codebase, which can be replicated in weeks, but the scenario library, the typed data model that links decisions to research frameworks, and the calibrated feedback model. All sit with the founding team.

A staged path to market

Acumen's business model is built around staged market entry, not a single target customer. The Business Model Canvas describes the broad beachhead; the Value Proposition Canvas focuses on the premium later segment. The relationship between them is sequential, not contradictory.

Beachhead via the BMC

At MVP stage Acumen pursues business students, young professionals, and aspiring founders. They are reachable through universities and societies. Acquisition cost is low, willingness to test is high, and feedback loops are fast. Revenue in this layer is freemium, with paid scenario packs and saved progress.

Premium via the VPC

The Value Proposition Canvas focuses on NextGen successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses. Their pains are structural: senior resistance to handover and the absence of a safe space to practise difficult decisions [1]. Revenue here comes from institutional pilots, but only after the loop is proven on the broader beachhead.

Revenue streams

Acumen runs three streams: freemium individual converting to a paid scenario pack (live), institutional cohort licences for universities and societies (in outreach), and a premium NextGen programme (roadmap).

STREAM	PRICE POINT	YEAR-1 TARGET VOLUME	YEAR-1 REVENUE (ILLUSTRATIVE)
Individual scenario pack	£9 one-off	1,200 unlocks	£10,800
University cohort licence	£1,500 per society / cohort	6 institutions	£9,000
NextGen pilot programme	£8,000 per cohort	1 paid pilot	£8,000
Total Year-1 revenue (target)			£27,800

Cost structure

The cost base is light at MVP stage. Dominant lines are scenario authoring, serverless hosting, and a small UCL-focused marketing budget. Founder time is shadow-priced for transparency but not drawn.

LINE	YEAR-1 ESTIMATE	NOTES
Scenario authoring and expert review	£6,000	~20 scenarios at MVP cost; expert review on contributor agreement.
Hosting and infrastructure	£1,200	Serverless backend; cost scales with usage.
Marketing and acquisition	£3,500	UCL society events, targeted LinkedIn, content.
Tooling, design, legal	£2,300	Trade-mark filing, design tooling, contractor support.
Total Year-1 cost	£13,000	Founder time is shadow-priced, not drawn.

First-year cash flow and roadmap

Monthly and cumulative cash flow

The chart below traces a conservative Year-1 trajectory under the volume targets above. The model assumes individual scenario revenue ramps from month three (after the first cohort pilot drives word-of-mouth), the university cohort licences land in months four, six, eight, ten, and eleven, and the single NextGen pilot closes in month nine. Costs are spread roughly evenly across the year. Net monthly cash flow turns positive in month four; cumulative cash flow ends Year 1 at approximately **£14,800**.

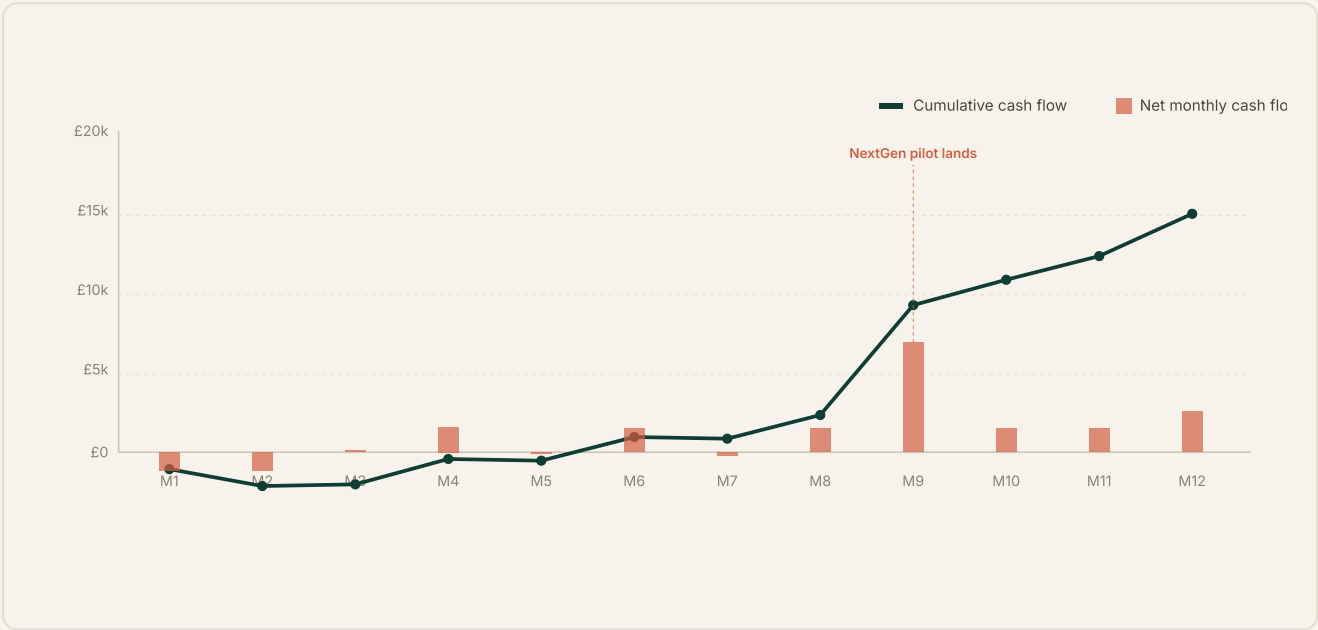


FIG. 8 Year-1 cash flow projection. Conservative ramp; founder time shadow-priced. Cumulative cash flow ends Year 1 at approximately £14,800.

Now / Next / Later

NOW · MVP

- Three live web scenarios
- Research-informed feedback profile
- Peer discovery via profile similarity
- Freemium plus paid scenario pack

NEXT · 6–12 MONTHS

- iOS and Android build for public launch
- Additional scenarios across functions
- UCL and society cohort pilots
- First paying institutional licence

LATER · 12–24 MONTHS

- Institutional pilots at scale
- Verified completion certificates
- NextGen succession pathway
- B2B advisory or recruiter tools

Out of scope at MVP. CV parsing, global map matching, paid certificates, recruiter dashboards, and fully validated scoring sit on the roadmap rather than in the current product.

What users have told us so far

Three exploratory interviews and a short student survey were used to test early assumptions about the problem and the proposed solution. Sample sizes are small, so findings are directional rather than conclusive. They are most useful for surfacing hypotheses to test in the next cohort, not for projecting market behaviour at scale.

How we ran it

Three in-depth, semi-structured interviews of 20–25 minutes each covered a final-year UCL student, an early-career professional in a first management role, and a pre-incorporation founder. Each followed a three-part guide: **pain points**, **concept reaction** after a prototype walkthrough, and **willingness to pay** (full guide in Appendix B). A five-question survey ran in parallel through UCL student networks: **18 responses** (12 students, 4 early-career, 2 founders) — directional, not representative.

Survey snapshot, n = 18

Few chances to practise judgement	15 / 18
Want feedback on how I decide	13 / 18
Networking events feel transactional	11 / 18
Would try a 15-minute simulation	12 / 18
Would pay for advanced scenarios	5 / 18
Respondents agreeing or strongly agreeing on a 5-point scale. Small sample; treat as directional only.	

FIG. 9 Problem-statement agreement, n = 18.

Voices from interviews

"The hardest part is not knowing if a decision was actually a good one. You make the call, things happen, and you never really get told why it worked or did not."

INTERVIEWEE A · FINAL-YEAR STUDENT

"LinkedIn is fine for the photo of you at a conference. It is not where you find the person you would actually phone before a hard meeting. I would pay if a tool genuinely got me better at deciding under pressure, and met me two or three people through it I wanted to know."

INTERVIEWEE B · EARLY-CAREER PROFESSIONAL

"I am not sure why I need to practise leadership when I am trying to start my own business but I will not be employing anyone any time soon, there are more important skills to be working on."

INTERVIEWEE C · ASPIRING FOUNDER, PRE-INCORPORATION

Reaction to the prototype

After the open pain-point discussion, each interviewee was walked through the Acumen prototype and asked the same set of concept-reaction questions. Survey respondents who indicated openness to the idea (n = 12) were asked the same closing prompts in a free-text field. Three signals are useful to surface: intention to use, perceived value of the loop, and not least, the dissenting view.

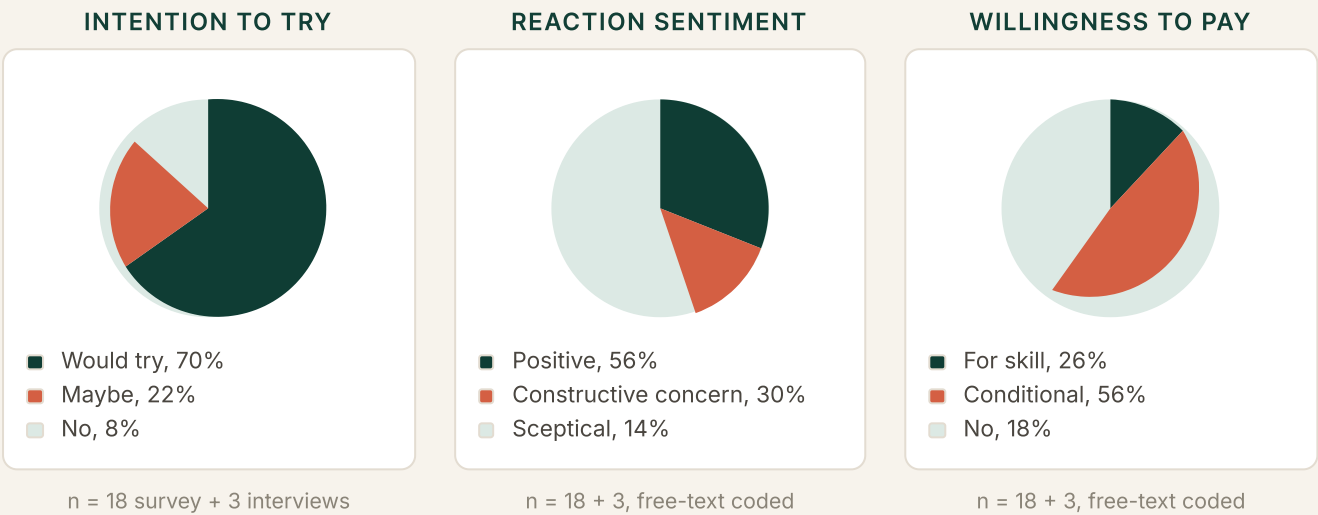


FIG. 10 Three pie charts of post-prototype reaction across survey free-text (n = 18) and interviews (n = 3), coded by the team.

What people most want from the loop

Feedback I can act on	11 / 12
Real scenarios, not abstract cases	9 / 12
Useful peer connections	8 / 12
Short, repeatable sessions	7 / 12
Mobile-friendly	11 / 12
Verifiable certificate	2 / 12

Features mentioned unprompted in free-text by the 12 survey respondents who said they would try Acumen.

FIG. 11 Feature mentions in concept-reaction free text, n = 12.

Why the founder concern matters

The sceptical voice on page 10, Interviewee C, is the most strategically useful response of the three. It points at **scope**: at a very early founder stage, decision practice can feel less urgent than product work, fundraising, or a first hire. The same concern surfaced in three of the survey free-text responses from self-identified founders.

The response is not to widen Acumen's scope but to position it more honestly: it helps anyone deciding earlier than expected, but does not replace technical or commercial skill-building. Copy and onboarding now make the distinction explicit.

Read together, the three charts suggest the proposition lands as concept (70% would try, 56% positive) but willingness-to-pay is conditional: people pay for skill they can feel, not for a certificate they cannot.

What we heard, and what changed

Patterns across the three interviews

With only three conversations, we report what was said rather than how many "agreed". The matrix below summarises whether each interviewee raised the topic without prompting, raised it after prompting, or did not raise it at all. It is offered as a record of the interviews, not as a quantitative finding.

TOPIC	A · STUDENT	B · PRO	C · FOUNDER
Wanted feedback on past decisions	● Unprompted	⦿ After prompt	○ Not raised
LinkedIn-style networks felt shallow	● Unprompted	● Unprompted	⦿ After prompt
Preferred interactive over course-style	● Unprompted	● Unprompted	● Unprompted
Would prefer to use on mobile	● Unprompted	● Unprompted	● Unprompted
Concerned about thin user base at launch	○ Not raised	● Unprompted	⦿ After prompt
Sceptical of "scoring" framing	⦿ After prompt	● Unprompted	⦿ After prompt
Sceptical of leadership practice as a priority	○ Not raised	○ Not raised	● Unprompted
Would pay for skill, not certificates	⦿ After prompt	● Unprompted	⦿ After prompt

● Raised without prompting ⦿ Raised after prompt ○ Not raised in this interview

What changed because of the interviews

Four product decisions followed. The leadership signal was reframed as developmental rather than diagnostic, after scepticism about single-session grading. Peer matching moved earlier in the journey, since the network was described as the most distinctive part of the proposition. The mobile build was promoted from "later" to "launch" — all three interviewees said unprompted they would prefer to use Acumen on their phone. Copy and onboarding were rewritten to be honest about scope: Acumen helps anyone deciding earlier than expected, but does not replace product or commercial skill-building.

The cold-start concern

Interviewee B raised the sharpest concern: *"the matching only works if there are actually people in there worth meeting."* The other two agreed when asked. The response is the cohort-pilot model: rather than a sparse public launch, Acumen seeds the network through closed cohort pilots (UCL societies first, then a course tie-in), so everyone in the matching pool starts on the same day — guaranteeing a meaningful network at first contact.

What still needs testing

Three questions remain open, informing R1, R2, and R6 in Section 9: whether users return, whether the signal is understood without facilitator, and whether a society signs a paying pilot. Next validation runs on a 40-user UCL cohort with telemetry on completion, return, and peer-message rates rather than self-report alone.

SWOT and competitive structure

Two short analyses are used: a SWOT to frame Acumen's internal position, and Porter's Five Forces to frame the external structure of the market.

SWOT

STRENGTHS

- Clear simulation-based MVP
- Strong link to leadership readiness research
- Broad student beachhead with premium NextGen pathway
- Differentiated blend of decision practice and networking

WEAKNESSES

- Scoring is research-informed, not validated
- Peer matching is still demo data
- Some roadmap features are not implemented
- Needs more user testing before stronger claims

OPPORTUNITIES

- Universities and societies can provide early cohorts
- APAC family-business succession is a high-value later market
- Simulations can become more culturally specific over time
- Peer network can create retention if enough users join

THREATS

- Generic AI coaching tools may look like substitutes
- McKinsey, LinkedIn, Coursera, or assessment firms could move into simulations
- Weak validation could damage credibility
- Users may see feedback as generic if not explained well

What the SWOT actually tells us

The pattern across the four cells is consistent. Acumen's strengths cluster around clarity and design: the loop is easy to explain in one sentence, the research grounding is verifiable, and the combined practice-and-network proposition is differentiated. Its weaknesses cluster around proof: the feedback model is research-informed but not yet calibrated, peer matching runs on demonstration data, and the user base is too small to make statistical claims. The opportunities are addressable in the short term, starting with a UCL or society cohort pilot. The threats are largely competitive rather than technical, and they sharpen the case for moving quickly on validation rather than on feature breadth. The honest reading is that Acumen has a defensible product story but a thin evidence base, and that closing the evidence gap is more valuable than building anything new.

Porter's Five Forces

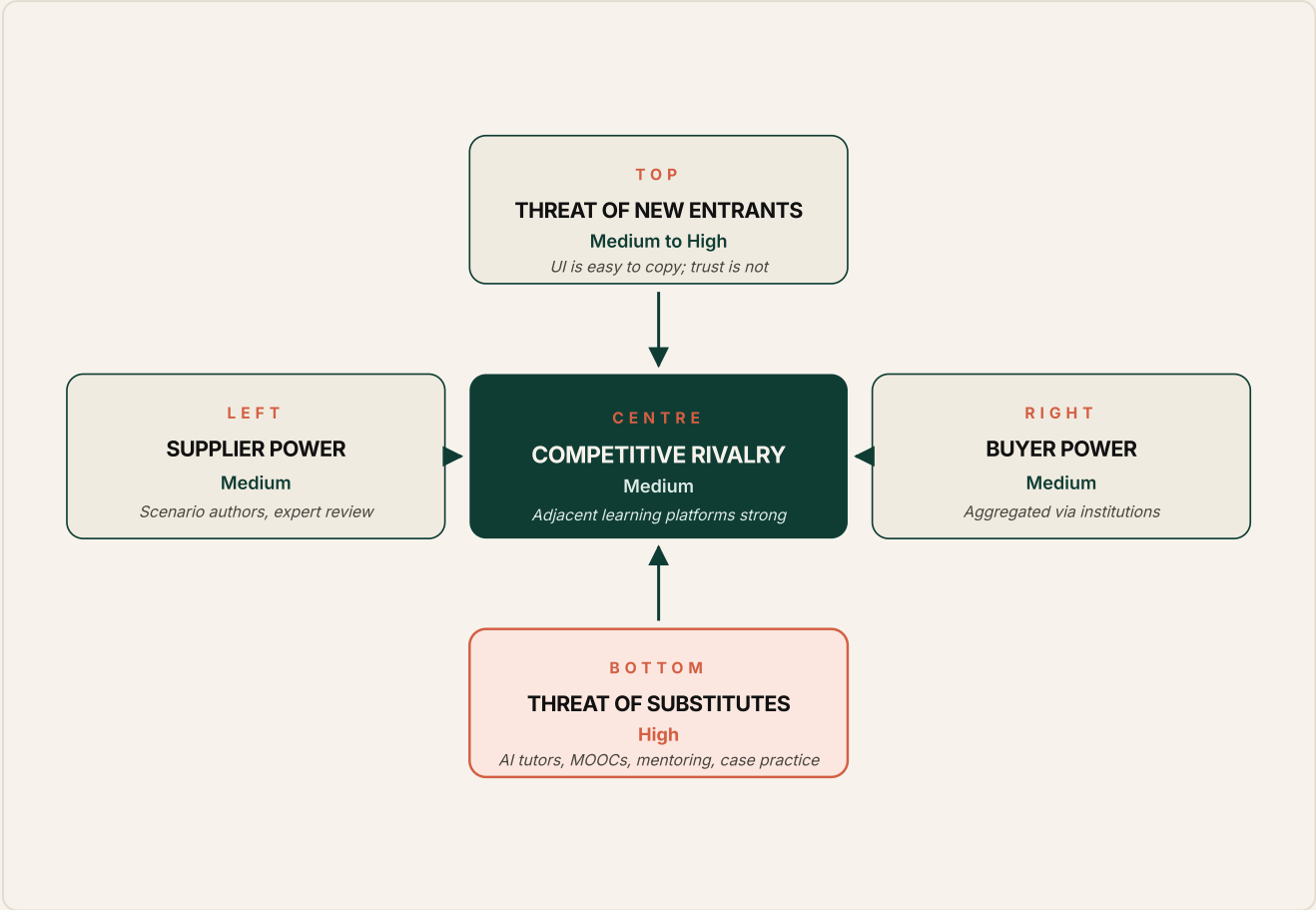


FIG. 12 Porter's Five Forces, with Acumen's interpretation of pressure on each force.

FORCE	PRESSURE	REPORT POINT
Competitive rivalry	Medium	Few direct competitors combine simulations, feedback, and peer matching; adjacent platforms are strong.
Threat of substitutes	High	AI tutors, LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, mentoring, and case practice substitute easily.
Buyer power	Medium	Students are price sensitive; universities and societies aggregate demand.
Supplier power	Medium	Scenario quality and credibility depend on expert input.
Threat of new entrants	Medium-High	UI is easy to copy; credible scoring, contextual scenarios, and network density are harder.

Where Acumen actually competes

The strongest pressure comes from substitutes — AI tutors, Coursera, mentors, casebooks — all cheaper. Acumen wins, if at all, by offering what they do not: a structured decision under pressure, defensible feedback, and a peer who made the same call differently. UI clones in weeks; calibrated feedback and an active peer network do not. Invest in scenario depth, validation, and network density.

From research to product decisions

The evidence map below shows how each major research finding translated into a concrete product decision. It is the simplest way to demonstrate that Acumen is not a generic edtech idea, but a product designed against a specific body of research.

RESEARCH FINDING	PRODUCT DECISION
Succession and governance are high-stakes in APAC family businesses [1][2]	Use succession and governance scenarios as flagship and premium content.
Indonesian family companies are central to GDP and market capitalisation [7]	Anchor scenario stakes in realistic regional business contexts.
Political and family ties shape decisions in regional contexts [9]	Build politically connected stakeholders into scenario decision trees.
Young users need practical business learning, not more content	Launch with short interactive simulations rather than long courses.
Serious games can support soft-skill assessment [14]	Use interactive decision simulations as the unit of practice.
Game-based assessment is used in serious professional settings [4][5]	Frame Acumen against an existing professional precedent rather than as a novelty.
Peer networks support learning and opportunity discovery	Add complementary peer matching directly to the loop.
Assessment validity takes time and data [8]	Frame scoring as research-informed, not validated, at MVP stage.

The pattern in the right-hand column is deliberate. Each product decision is traceable to a finding, not assumed from intuition, and where the finding is weak the product framing softens accordingly. Scoring is described as research-informed rather than validated because Imbellus and McKinsey took several years and a large candidate dataset to calibrate equivalent instruments [5][8]; claiming the same standard at MVP stage would be dishonest. The flagship scenario is anchored in the region the literature flags as most stressed by succession [1], but the broader scenario library is not regionally locked, which keeps the beachhead inclusive of users with no family-business context.

A balanced verdict

Acumen is a feasible early-stage MVP with a coherent beachhead, a research-backed premium pathway, and a clear product loop. Its next challenge is not building more features, but validating whether users trust and return to the simulation, feedback, and peer loop.

Where the MVP stands across four lenses

LENS	VERDICT	REASONING
Technical	Feasible	Scenario engine, weighted-tag feedback model, and profile-vector matching are implemented and stable; three scenarios live; conventional, cheap stack.
Strategic	Coherent	Reaching NextGen successors via a student/society beachhead is internally consistent and matches the literature.
Commercial	Promising, unproven	Strong on the problem (83% agree on lack of practice) but soft on willingness to pay (34%); no paid pilot yet — the largest open question.
Research	Backed	Leadership theory, succession evidence, and serious-games literature support the design. Scoring validation is not at Imbellus/McKinsey level [5][8]; we do not claim otherwise.

What we deliberately do not claim

Three caveats: three exploratory interviews are directional, not proof of demand; Acumen offers research-informed developmental feedback, not validated psychometric assessment; CV parsing, global maps, recruiter tools, certificates, and fully validated scoring sit on the roadmap.

The five hypotheses we now have to test

Listed in priority order; the first two carry the most product risk.

#	HYPOTHESIS	HOW WE WILL TEST IT	PASS THRESHOLD
H1	Users return for a second scenario within 14 days of their first.	Cohort tracking on a UCL pilot of 40+ users.	≥ 35% return rate.
H2	Users understand and trust the leadership signal without facilitator explanation.	Five-minute post-session interviews with 15 users; comprehension scoring against a four-point rubric.	≥ 12 of 15 score 3 or above.
H3	A university society will run a cohort pilot of 40+ members.	Outreach to UCL Entrepreneurs Society, UCL Investment Society, and one external society.	One signed pilot agreement by end of June 2026.
H4	Users find peer matches valuable enough to message.	Telemetry on profile views and outbound messages within the pilot cohort.	≥ 25% of completing users send at least one peer message.
H5	NextGen successors find scenario realism credible.	Three exploratory interviews with NextGen contacts via family-business advisors.	Qualitative agreement on three of four scenario realism dimensions.

SMART next steps and limits of this study

SMART recommendations for the next six months

Each action is specific, measurable, achievable, realistic, and timebound. Owners are placeholders to be filled in by the team at kickoff.

#	ACTION	MEASURE	DEADLINE	OWNER
R1	Run a 40-user UCL cohort pilot of <i>The Succession Crisis</i> with telemetry on completion, return, and peer-message rates.	40 completed sessions; H1 and H4 thresholds met.	30 Jun 2026	Maya
R2	Conduct 15 post-session comprehension interviews to test the feedback signal language.	12 of 15 score 3+ on the rubric.	15 Jul 2026	Daniel
R3	Author and ship two new scenarios (one operational, one ethical) to widen practice surface beyond succession.	Both scenarios live, expert-reviewed by a UCL faculty member.	31 Jul 2026	Moritz
R4	Ship iOS and Android builds via React Native, sharing scenario engine and feedback model with the web bundle.	Both apps in TestFlight and Play Internal Testing; smoke tests passing.	15 Aug 2026	Daniel
R5	Calibrate the feedback model against five expert raters on a held-out scenario set.	Inter-rater agreement $\kappa \geq 0.5$ on three of five dimensions.	31 Aug 2026	Daniel
R6	Sign one paying pilot with a society or course, even at a nominal price, to test willingness to pay.	One signed agreement; revenue collected.	30 Sep 2026	Maya
R7	Run three exploratory NextGen interviews via family-business advisors to begin testing the premium pathway.	Three completed interviews with notes shared internally.	31 Oct 2026	Moritz

Limitations of this study

Three limitations matter most. The primary research is small (18 survey responses, three in-depth interviews) — figures in Section 7 are directional, not representative. Access to NextGen successors is second-hand: we have read the PwC and McKinsey work but not interviewed Asian family-business successors directly. The feedback model is not yet calibrated against expert ratings; Imbellus and McKinsey needed years and a substantial dataset for high-stakes calibration [5][8]. These are why scoring is framed as developmental and the cohort pilot is the most important next step.

The argument in one line

Research shows a leadership-readiness gap. Acumen tests whether short simulations can help emerging leaders practise judgement, receive useful feedback, and form valuable peer connections. The MVP demonstrates the loop is buildable. The next six months — one cohort pilot, a calibrated feedback model, a paying pilot, and three NextGen interviews — will tell us whether users return, and whether they return for the right reasons.

Business Model Canvas

The full Acumen Business Model Canvas, completed using the official Strategyzer template. The canvas describes the broad beachhead segment (students and early-career professionals) rather than the premium NextGen tier, which is treated separately in the Value Proposition Canvas overleaf.

The Business Model Canvas		Designed for: Young people looking to upskill and connect in business understanding	Designed by:	Date:	Version:			
Key Partnerships  UCL societies (Entrepreneurship Society, Investment society) for cohort pilots UCL faculty for expert scenario review APAC family business advisors Cloud infrastructure providers (AWS)	Key Activities  Authoring and expert review of the scenarios (editorial work that makes the products USP and value) Maintaining the typed scenario data model and scoring engines Running cohort pilots and capturing telemetry (completion, return, etc...)	Value Propositions  Practise judgement on realistic scenarios under simulated pressure, not abstract case studies. A research informed leadership Signal in plain language. Peer matching by complementary, meet people whose strengths fill yours Short, repeatable sessions that fit in between lectures or commutes.	Customer Relationships  Self serve digital product with cohort based onboarding (closed pilots, but not a spare public launch) Society or course partnerships rather than 1:1 sales Developmental tone, feedback is formative, not graded	Customer Segments  Business and engineering students (UCL beachhead) Young professionals, 0-4 years from graduation Aspiring founders Premium later: NextGen successors in APAC family businesses	Key Resources  Scenario library (3 live: succession crisis, Authority Bypass, Fading Division) Typed scenario data model + scoring rubric (defensible IP) Founding team's research / design capability Serverless web stack (Next.js, React, Typescript)	Channels  Appstore (IOs and Google Play) Facebook (Instagram) Ads Flyers on campus Promotional event days (gamified element) UCL societies and course tie ins (primary at MVP) Word of mouth from cohort pilots Family business advisors as the route to the NextGen segment	Cost Structure  Scenario authoring + expert review - £3000-6000 Hosting and serverless infrastructure - £1000 Marketing and acquisition (UCL/society events) - £3000 Tooling, design, trademark filing, legal - £1000	Revenue Streams  Individual scenario packs (£9 one off) University cohort licenses (£1500 per cohort, when product is ready) NextGen pilot programs (£8,000 per cohort - roadmapped) Not subscription, not recruiter tools, and no certificates at MVP



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Strategyzer
strategyzer.com

FIG. 13 Acumen Business Model Canvas (Strategyzer template), beachhead view.

Value Proposition Canvas · NextGen segment

The Value Proposition Canvas focuses on the premium later-stage segment, where willingness to pay is highest and the strategic stakes most acute: NextGen successors in Asia-Pacific family businesses preparing to take leadership without formal training pathways.

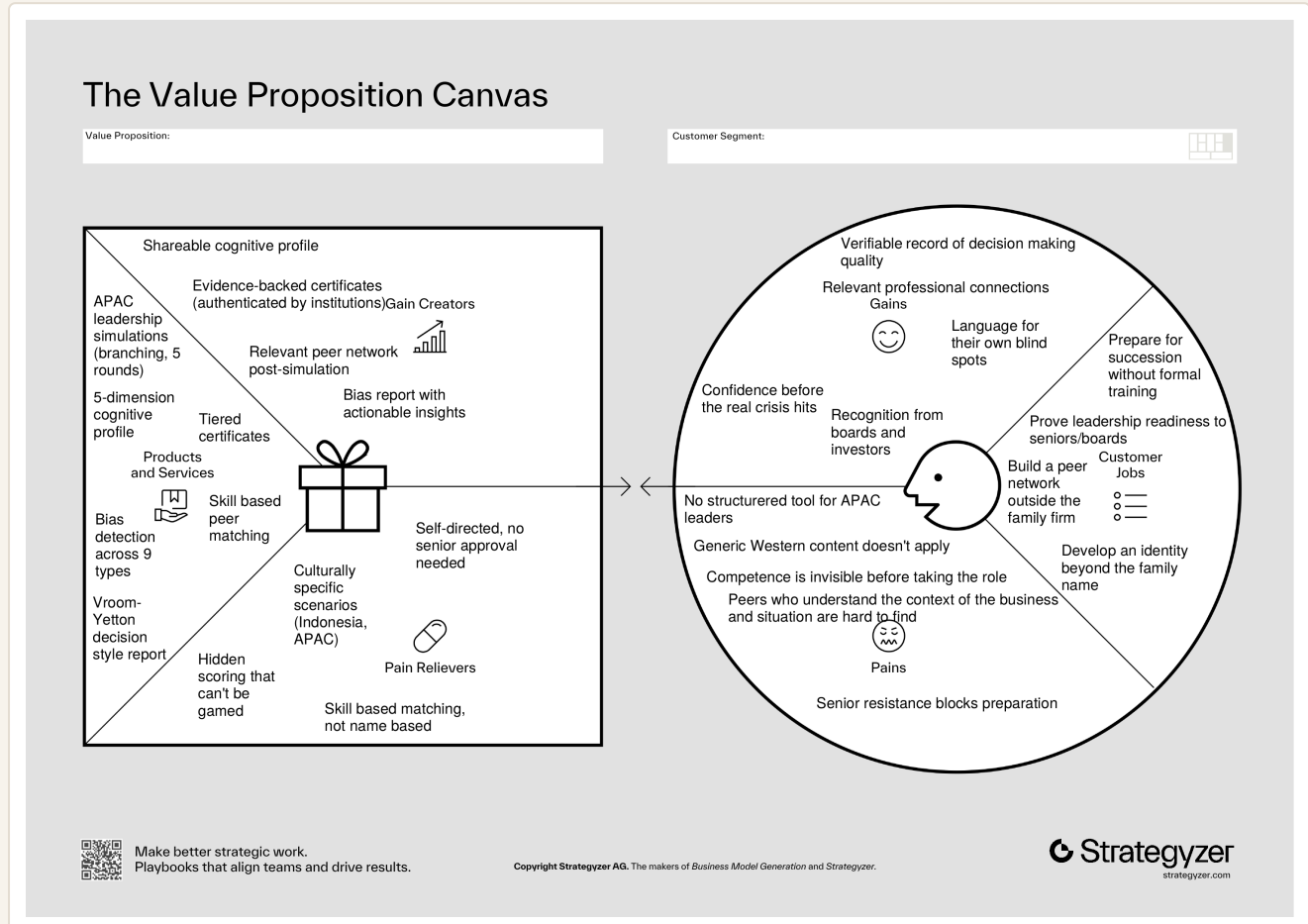


FIG. 14 Acumen Value Proposition Canvas (Strategyzer template), NextGen successor segment.

Research instruments and architecture

Interview guide · Pain points and gaps

- 1. What are the key skills you believe leadership and owning your own business require?
- 2. What do you find hardest about becoming a better leader or entrepreneur?
- 3. Do you feel like learning from others, especially people whose skills are different from yours, helps you grow? Or do you prefer to work independently?
- 4. How easy is it for you to meet people who actually challenge your thinking or complement your skills?
- 5. When you connect with people on platforms like LinkedIn, do those interactions actually lead to meaningful conversations?

Interview guide · Concept reaction

- 1. If there was a platform where you could go through real business scenarios and get feedback on your decisions, how useful would that be?
- 2. Have you ever been in a situation where you had to make a difficult business or leadership decision? What did you do?
- 3. Do you find it hard to connect with people through cold emailing, or are LinkedIn and similar networks not very in-depth?
- 4. Do you like simulative contextual games, and would you want to see how others with similar or contrasting situational judgement responded?
- 5. Would you prefer something like this to feel more like a structured course, or more like an interactive experience?

Interview guide · Profitability and value

- 1. If this platform could genuinely help you improve your decision-making and connect you with the right people, would you pay for it?
- 2. Which of these would matter more to you: certificates, skill improvement, networking opportunities, or career opportunities (if they were good)?
- 3. What would make you actually want to message or respond to someone on a platform like this?
- 4. If you could design the perfect platform to become a better leader, what would it look like?

Source audit summary

CLAIM	SOURCE
USD 5.8 trillion APAC NextGen wealth transfer	[3]
43% Indonesian NextGen citing senior resistance	[1]
PwC Global NextGen Survey 2024 sample	[2]
Indonesian family companies' role in GDP and market cap	[7]
Serious games and soft-skill assessment	[14]
McKinsey Game-Based Innovation Lab	[4]
Imbellus / McKinsey simulation calibration	[5][8]
Political connections in Indonesia	[9]
Upper-echelons / Vroom-Yetton / Hersey-Blanchard / Rest	[10][11][12][13]

Technical architecture

Acumen runs as a static client paired with a lightweight serverless backend for scenario state and profile storage. Scenarios are authored as decision graphs with weighted dimension tags; the feedback model aggregates these into a profile vector. Peer matching uses cosine similarity over profile vectors. No production user data beyond anonymised profile vectors is held at MVP stage.

Group charter and meeting log

Required by the brief to evidence equitable contribution. The charter sets expectations; the meeting log records progress, allocation, and any mitigations.

Group charter · Group 50

MEMBER	PRIMARY REMIT	SECONDARY CONTRIBUTION
Daniel Dutulescu	Product, scenario engine, feedback model design	Technical architecture, bibliography, co-author of the report
Maya Munasinghe	Market research, survey design, validation interviews	Business model, value proposition canvas, co-author of the report
Moritz Bode	Strategy, SWOT and Porter analysis, source audit	Visual identity, MVP walkthrough, co-author of the report

WORKING AGREEMENTS

1. Decisions are taken by simple consensus; if consensus cannot be reached after one meeting, the member with primary remit decides and the disagreement is logged.
2. Each member commits to an even share of writing and review.
3. Meetings happen weekly, with a fortnightly review of allocation against deliverables.
4. If a member is unable to deliver an allocated task, the group is informed at least 48 hours before the next meeting and the task is reallocated.
5. The module leader is informed promptly if any equity issues arise that the group cannot resolve internally, in line with the brief.

Meeting log and AI use

Meeting log

DATE	MODE	PRESENT / ABSENT	DECISIONS AND ALLOCATION	MITIGATIONS
17 Mar 2026	In person	All present	Confirmed Acumen as the venture. Allocated initial research areas across leadership theory, family-business succession, and serious-games literature.	None.
24 Mar 2026	In person	All present	Reviewed initial source audit. Decided on the broader-beachhead, premium-NextGen positioning. Drafted product loop.	None.
31 Mar 2026	Online	All present	Locked the four-step product loop. Daniel started scenario engine; Maya drafted survey; Moritz started SWOT and Porter analysis.	Survey instrument shortened to seven items after pilot review.
07 Apr 2026	In person	All present	Reviewed first scenario draft (<i>The Succession Crisis</i>). Maya conducted the first exploratory interview. Confirmed visual identity direction.	Scenario length reduced from 12 to 8 decision nodes after internal playtest.
14 Apr 2026	Online	All present	Second exploratory interview. Reframed the leadership signal as developmental rather than diagnostic following interview feedback. Moved peer matching forward in the loop.	None.
21 Apr 2026	In person	All present	Reviewed full draft. Agreed on hypothesis prioritisation and SMART recommendations. Allocated final report sections.	Word count contained by moving extended notes to the appendix.
28 Apr 2026	In person	All present	Final review of report layout, citations, and source audit. Submission preparation.	None.

Use of AI tools

Generative AI was used in an assistive role consistent with UCL guidance: for drafting and editing prose, layout iteration, and proofreading. All research claims, citations, hypotheses, recommendations, primary research instruments, and the scenario library are the team's own work. The team reviewed every AI-assisted passage for accuracy and tone before inclusion.

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ACUMEN

Practise judgement before it counts.

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